Hasmin M. Abdulhalim

Dr. Hasmin M. Abdulhalim, RL, MLIS, is the Director of the University Library at Mindanao State University (MSU) Main Campus in Marawi City, a position she assumed in February 2026 through Special Order No. 119-OP, Series of 2026, after more than two decades of teaching and administrative service within the university system.

A Registered Librarian with a PhD in Educational Administration and Supervision, she spent over twenty years as a full time faculty member in the Department of Library and Information Science before rising through the university's governance structures, including the University System Curriculum Committee, the Campus Quality Assurance Board, and the University Research Ethics Committee.

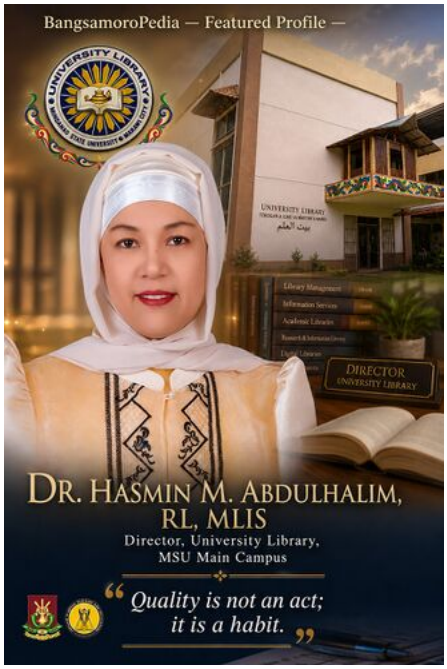
She is widely recognized for steering the University Library's post Marawi Siege transformation into a culturally inclusive, community centered space, complete with prayer and ablution rooms, and for championing library systems aligned with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals, particularly in support of individuals with psychosocial disabilities.

Beyond MSU, she served as President of the Philippine Librarians Association, Inc. (PLAI), BARMM Regional Council, from 2022 to 2023, advancing professional development and advocacy for librarians across the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao.

Contents

1 Overview
2 History of the MSU Main Campus Library
  2.1 A Sanctuary Amidst Crisis
  2.2 Space Reimagining and Cultural Integration
  2.3 Post Pandemic Upgrades and Partnership Era
3 Education
4 Career and Public Service
5 Leadership Roles
6 Contributions, Achievements, and Legacy
7 References

Dr. Hasmin M. Abdulhalim, RL, MLIS



Position

Director, University Library, MSU Main Campus

Institution

Mindanao State University (Main Campus, Marawi City)

Credentials

RL, MLIS, PhD in Educational Administration and Supervision

Years in Service

20+ years (MSU System)

Notability

Named Director of the MSU Main Campus University Library in February 2026, capping over two decades of service as a faculty member and administrator within the university system.

Known For

Reimagining the University Library into a culturally inclusive space with prayer and ablution rooms, and championing SDG-aligned, disability-conscious library systems for the Meranaw community.

Pull Quote

"A library isn't just where books live: it's where a community finds its footing again."

Overview

Dr. Hasmin M. Abdulhalim, RL, MLIS, is a prominent academic administrator and educator at Mindanao State University (MSU) Main Campus in Marawi City.

Serving as the University Library Director, she is a central figure in advancing the institution's academic ecosystem, knowledge preservation, and administrative systems.

Before ascending to her institutional leadership role, Dr. Abdulhalim spent over two decades as a full time faculty member in the Department of Library and Information Science under the College of Social Sciences and Humanities (CSSH).

Beyond her campus contributions, she has served as a regional leader in the Philippine library community, driving modernization and professional growth in library sciences across the region.

History of the MSU Main Campus Library

The history of the University Library is deeply intertwined with the evolution of Mindanao State University, which was established in 1961 through Republic Act 1387 to serve the educational and cultural needs of Southern Philippines.

Since its inception, the main campus library in Marawi City has functioned as the intellectual heart of the campus.

A Sanctuary Amidst Crisis

Over the decades, the library transitioned from a traditional repository of books into a vital community hub.

During the devastating Marawi Siege of 2017, when much of the surrounding city faced destruction, the MSU Main Campus became a haven of institutional resilience.

In the post conflict recovery period, students famously dubbed the University Library their "happy place." It was one of the few vibrant spaces where students from diverse cultural backgrounds gathered not just to study, but to find a sense of normalcy, safety, and community.

Space Reimagining and Cultural Integration

In April 2019, the library administration launched an ambitious modernization initiative themed "Transforming Lives: Re imagining, Re tooling, and Re creating the University Library."

This project fundamentally adapted the facility to serve its predominantly Muslim student body and the local community more holistically.

Key historical upgrades included the Banggolo Reading Room, the transformation of the second floor into a spacious, high capacity study area to accommodate the dense population of student researchers.

Ablution and prayer rooms were also introduced: the building became uniquely inclusive by installing dedicated male and female ablution spaces alongside separate prayer rooms, directly supporting the religious and daily routines of its users.

Infrastructure improvements followed as well, including a dedicated water pump system, integrated to maintain sanitation standards independent of the city's wider municipal struggles.

Post Pandemic Upgrades and Partnership Era

Following years of hybrid operations and structural adjustments, the library officially resumed full regular operations and centralized research assistance services on July 13, 2026.

To overcome the physical limitations of its geographic location, the university entered into a landmark resource sharing partnership with the University of the Philippines (UP) in late 2025.

Facilitated by the MSU Board of Regents, this collaboration systematically links MSU's academic community with UP's digital databases and specialized catalogs.

Today, alongside its physical main building, the university operates a separate Digital Library and Institutional Repository located adjacent to the Aga Khan Museum.

This division is tasked with digitizing permanent university publications, multimedia collections, and historical artifacts that trace the institutional history of the region.

Education

Dr. Abdulhalim possesses an extensive academic background that bridges library sciences and educational leadership.

Her Master in Library and Information Science (MLIS) provided the theoretical foundations and technical skills necessary for her lifelong career in modern information systems and cataloging management.

Her Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) in Educational Administration and Supervision equipped her with the organizational governance capabilities required to steer complex, university wide academic units.

She holds professional credentialing as a Registered Librarian (RL) in the Philippines, having passed the national licensure examination mandated by the Professional Regulation Commission.

Career and Public Service

Dr. Abdulhalim's professional tenure at Mindanao State University spans more than twenty years, reflecting a steady rise from classroom teaching to university wide governance.

As an Associate Professor V within CSSH, she has trained generations of Filipino library professionals.

Her service portfolio demonstrates deep involvement in institutional quality control and academic integrity, and she has lent her regulatory and development expertise to several of the university's high level governing bodies.

Within the University System Curriculum Committee (USCC), she evaluated and refined academic programs across the university network.

As part of the Campus Quality Assurance Board, she served as the College Coordinator for Quality Assurance, aligning local curricula with international institutional benchmarks.

Through the University Research Ethics Committee, she helped ensure that academic and scientific inquiries conducted under the university's banner meet rigorous ethical and human subject protection protocols.

At the department level, she served as Chairperson of the Department of Library and Information Science, where she directly managed recruitment, program standards, and faculty development.

Leadership Roles

Dr. Abdulhalim reached a major career milestone in February 2026.

Through Special Order No. 119-OP, Series of 2026, issued by the MSU System President, Atty. Paisalin P.D. Tago, CPA, she was officially designated as the Director of the University Library for the MSU Main Campus.

On February 16, 2026, she officially took over the administrative reins from outgoing director Zaalica B. Edres during an official turnover ceremony witnessed by Executive Vice President Dr. Abdulcader M. Ayo.

Her leadership also extends significantly beyond campus borders. She served as the President of the Philippine Librarians Association, Inc. (PLAI), BARMM Regional Council, for the 2022 to 2023 term.

In this capacity, she spearheaded professional development programs and advocacy networks for librarians operating throughout the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao.

Contributions, Achievements, and Legacy

At the core of Dr. Abdulhalim's legacy is her dedication to making information spaces socio culturally inclusive and aligned with global standards.

Her modern administrative strategies directly connect local library resources to broader developmental metrics.

On community inclusivity, Dr. Abdulhalim initiated a public access framework allowing local Marawi City residents free entry to university library services every Friday, breaking down institutional barriers between the campus and the public.

On sustainability and SDG alignment, she has championed institutional data collection tailored to the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), specifically targeting SDG 10 (Reduced Inequalities) by adapting library tracking systems to capture support structures for individuals with psychosocial disabilities, such as ADHD.

On institutional stewardship, by bridging the gap between historical print archives and modern digital repositories, she continues to direct the preservation of fragile documentation reflecting the rich cultural heritage of the Meranaw people and the broader Mindanao frontier.

References

[1] Personal Data Sheet / source PDF, cross checked and verified by Grok.

[2] MSU Main Campus institutional records.

[3] Philippine Librarians Association, Inc. (PLAI), BARMM Regional Council records.

Editorial Notice: BangsamoroPedia is a curated knowledge archive. Its pages are maintained by the editorial administrator to help ensure historical accuracy. If you would like to suggest corrections, share sources, or

contribute information, please message the administrator through the official Facebook page: **Notable Muslim Filipinos**.

Retrieved from "https://wiki.maranaw.com/index.php?title=Hasmin_M._Abdulhalim&oldid=3179"